INCLUSIVE LEADERSHIP

Social Justice & Long-Term Strategy

Building Equitable, Sustainable Organizations

Youth Advocate Networks | Rwanda

INCLUSIVE LEADERSHIP

Equity Over Equality

Give people what they need, not the same thing

Representation

Diverse voices in leadership & decisions

Accessibility

Remove barriers from the start

Cultural Humility

Listen, learn & adapt always

Power Sharing

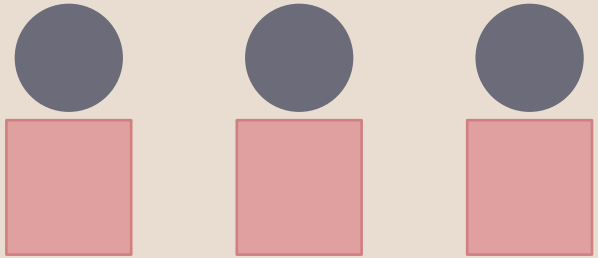
Let marginalized groups lead

Creating environments where ALL people can participate, contribute & lead

EQUITY VS. EQUALITY

EQUALITY

Same resources for everyone



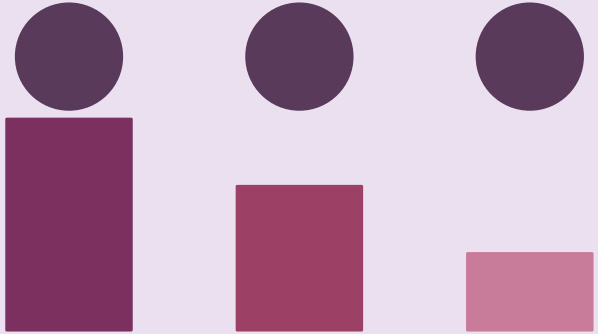
✗ Ignores different starting points

May perpetuate inequality

VS

EQUITY

Different support for equal outcomes



✓ Addresses different starting points

Creates conditions for everyone to succeed

GENDER AWARENESS & EQUALITY

LEADERSHIP

CHALLENGE

Women underrepresented in leadership

ACTION

Set 50% targets · Mentorship programs

ECONOMIC

CHALLENGE

Barriers to employment & entrepreneurship

ACTION

Childcare support · Skills training

SAFETY

CHALLENGE

Gender-based violence limits participation

ACTION

Anti-harassment policies · Safe spaces

CULTURE

CHALLENGE

Stereotypes limit girls' ambitions

ACTION

Challenge norms · Engage men as allies

DISABILITY INCLUSION

Social Model

Society's barriers cause disability — not the person

Nothing Without Us

People with disabilities design their own solutions

Universal De

Accessible from the start — not retrofitted

5%

of Rwanda

has a disability

PRACTICAL ACTIONS

- Ramps & accessible toilets
- Sign language interpreters
- Materials in multiple formats
- Ask about accessibility needs
- Budget for assistive devices
- Train staff on disability etiquette

CHILD RIGHTS & SAFEGUARDING

1

Non-Discrimination

Every child has rights regardless of race, gender, or background

2

Best Interests of Child

All decisions must put children first

3

Right to Life & Development

Children develop physically, mentally & socially

4

Respect Their Views

Children's voices matter in decisions affecting them

SAFEGUARDING ESSENTIALS

- ✓ Background checks
- ✓ Code of conduct
- ✓ Reporting channels
- ✓ Trained staff
- ✓ Survivor support

MENTAL HEALTH SENSITIVITY

Normalize

Talk openly · Share resources · Avoid stigma

Safe Spaces

No judgment · Respect privacy · Trauma awareness

Support

Counseling access · Mental health days · First aid training

Reduce Burnout

Realistic workloads · Breaks · Lead by example

Inclusive Design

Thoughtful scheduling · Quiet spaces · Content warnings

Stigma prevents people from seeking help. Break the silence.

SOCIAL JUSTICE ETHICS

	CHARITY APPROACH	JUSTICE APPROACH
Root Causes	*Give school supplies to poor children*	**Advocate for government education funding**
Community	*Design what you think people need*	**Co-create solutions with communities**
Power	*Work within existing systems*	**Challenge why groups are excluded**
Dignity	*Provide services to beneficiaries*	**Build community agency & ownership**

STRATEGIC PLANNING

VISION

Your inspiring dream of the future

Inspiring · Ambitious
Concise · Future-focused

"A Rwanda where all youth have equal opportunities to lead"

+

MISSION

What you do, who you serve, how

Purposeful · Actionable
Specific · People-centered

"We empower marginalized youth through leadership & advocacy"

SETTING LONG-TERM GOALS

S

Specific

Clearly defined — who, what, where, why

e.g., Train 500 young women in advocacy skills

M

Measurable

Quantifiable indicators to track progress

e.g., Increase girls' STEM enrollment by 30%

A

Achievable

Realistic given your resources & context

e.g., Launch 10 youth-led projects

R

Relevant

Aligned with your mission & stakeholder needs

e.g., Address barriers youth actually face

T

Time-Bound

Has a clear deadline or timeframe

e.g., By Dec 2028, youth councils in 15 districts

INSTITUTIONAL GOVERNANCE

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

5-9 members · Quarterly meetings · Term limits

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

Implements strategy
Manages operations

GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Ultimate authority
Elects board members

ADVISORY COMMITTEES

Technical expertise
Community voices

GOVERNANCE PRINCIPLES

- Transparency
- Accountability
- Clear Authority
- Conflict of Interest Rules
- Financial Controls
- Succession Planning

RISK & SUCCESSION PLANNING

COMMON RISKS

Financial	Funding cuts · Fraud · Budget shortfalls	→ Diversify sources · Audits · Build reserves
Operational	Staff leaving · Project delays	→ Succession plan · Backup systems
Reputational	Scandals · Negative coverage	→ Safeguarding · Crisis comms plan
Legal	Non-compliance · Contract disputes	→ Legal advice · Proper documentation
Safety	Staff harm · Data breaches	→ Safety protocols · Data protection

SUCCESSION PLANNING

1. Identify critical roles
2. Develop internal talent
3. Document processes
4. Transition planning
5. Handover & support

KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. Inclusive leadership requires intentional action — equity, access & power-sharing
2. Equity ≠ Equality. Give people what they need, not the same thing
3. Design programs WITH marginalized communities, not FOR them
4. Social justice addresses root causes — not just symptoms
5. Strategic planning (vision + mission + SMART goals) provides direction
6. Governance, succession & risk management protect your future
7. Safeguarding, inclusion & governance policies build trust & prevent harm

LEAD WITH INCLUSION

Building equitable, sustainable organizations requires

intention · strategy · accountability

Youth Advocate Networks | Rwanda

Everyone belongs. Everyone contributes. Everyone thrives.